

## Galio

**Funding:** US\$ 295,031 pledged of US\$ 8,000 goal

**Link:** <https://dgit.in/Galio>

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ith Galio, a portable USB-C charger, developer Baseus had one goal – cram in the maximum power into the smallest form factor possible.

This was made possible by utilising gallium nitride and silicon carbide (GaN+SiC) technology which allowed for a compact, yet high-power charger. By using GaN+SiC, the resulting charger is about as large as an average credit card and 15 percent smaller than Apple's 96w USB-C power adapter. The Galio provides a whopping 120w of power which is enough to charge three devices at the same time, with ease. At full speed, no less. It

charges devices up to five times faster than a traditional charger of the same size. The Galio packs three USB ports – two Type-C ports, each rated at 100W (max) and one standard USB port rated at 30W (max). To



support the high power output, the Galio comes equipped with multiple built-in safeguards including protection against overcurrent, overvoltage, overcharging and overheating to ensure safe fast charging. The company claims that Galio can support various quick charging protocols, delivering fast charge to whatever device you can throw at it. When all three ports are in use, the Galio is capable of outputting 60W+30W+30W to three devices simultaneously. If you're just charging two laptops, you will get 60W+60W output resulting in some blazing fast charging times! The Galio even comes with foldable prongs (US pins), making it more pocket-friendly. There's even a UK version equipped with the standard prongs we use in India.



## òPik

**Funding:** US\$ 16,439 pledged of US\$ 20,960 goal

**Link:** <https://dgit.in/òPik>

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he òPik is an optical guitar pickup which can be programmed via a smartphone. It overhauls the traditional magnetic guitar pickups by adding customizability. The company claims that òPik is the first and only programmable pickup in the world. The pickup is shaped like a traditional one but instead uses infrared LEDs to convert string vibrations into a signal, which is then outputted through a guitar amp. There are two strips of these infrared LEDs on the device. When the string above these LEDs vibrate, it is picked up instantly by a photodiode receptor (optical receptor) and then turned into a signal, as mentioned above. The òPik is designed to fit easily in the standard hamburger pickup slot in guitars and it is easy to install as well. The company is also working on developing a unit that can sit at the neck position too. The òPik works with any type of guitar strings, including even nylon ones! So, enthusiasts can mix and match different strings to create a more vibrant, customised sound. The manufacturers claim that the device works well with effects pedals as well. On the accompanying app, you can adjust each string's volume separately and even tweak cutoff frequencies. You can also change around the balance and tone of your guitar. These settings are saved and can be transferred to another òPik, shared with friends or even on the òPik sound gallery.

## CODY BLOCK

**Funding:** US\$ 57,211 pledged of US\$ 77,493 goal

**Link:** <https://dgit.in/codyblock>

**“A**

Montessori inspired, screen-free, gender neutral wooden toy”. This is how the developers at the company QUBS define their invention CODY BLOCK. The wooden toy is, however, not a simple one but one that teaches children (ages 3-9) the basics of computational thinking and coding through play. CODY BLOCK features a small, motorised wooden toy car which drives along the wooden city.

The city consists of other wooden building blocks, each implanted with 125kHz RFID tags. The wooden buildings act as directional commands to the car – turn left, turn right, U-turn, repeat last command and more – the commands are depicted with pictorial signs on the blocks. The children will have to arrange



the command wooden blocks in such a way that the car (Cody) reaches its destination successfully. The company terms this as 'hands-on programming'. They believe that CODY BLOCK introduces children to the concepts of computational thinking by helping them program the blocks sequentially and strategically. Each wooden block is useful in creating a sequence of instructions for Cody the car which ultimately introduces children to the very basis of an algorithm. CODY BLOCK also comes with a City Guide which is brimming with exercises and adventures for different learning outcomes.